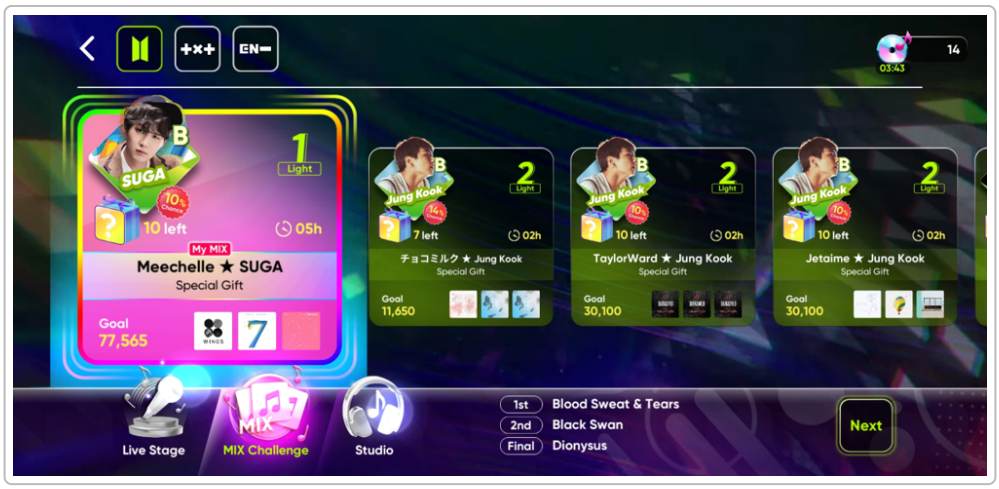
ChatGPT

Rhythm Hive: Comprehensive Overview (2026)

What it is and who made it: Rhythm Hive is a **free-to-play mobile rhythm game** from HYBE Entertainment's gaming arm. It launched globally on Feb 4, 2021 [1]. The game is developed by DRIMAGE Co., Ltd (formerly known as Superb Corp) under HYBE IM, and features licensed music by HYBE artists. It is available on both iOS and Android devices [2] [3]. The app has consistently received updates (latest Android update Dec 15, 2025 [4]), indicating it's still live into 2026. No shutdown or full service termination has been announced; however, on Dec 31, 2025 the developers *paused* all future NewJeans content (pending review) and assured players that **existing NewJeans cards and songs remain playable** [5].

Gameplay Mechanics & Modes: In Rhythm Hive you tap, hold (slide), and flick note markers in time with the music as they reach a judgment line (similar to other music games) [6] [7]. Notes can include standard taps, sliding trails (hold and follow), **flick notes** (swipes), and special yellow notes worth extra points [6] [8]. Hits are graded on accuracy: *Marvelous* (perfect) down through Excellent, Good, Fair, and Miss [9]; maintaining high-accuracy combos boosts scores. (A full Marvelous/Excellent combo is called "All Excellent"; all-Marvelous is "All Marvelous" [10].) Players also have an HP bar: misses or "Fair" hits deplete HP and can fail the song if it runs out (especially in Chapter mode) [11].

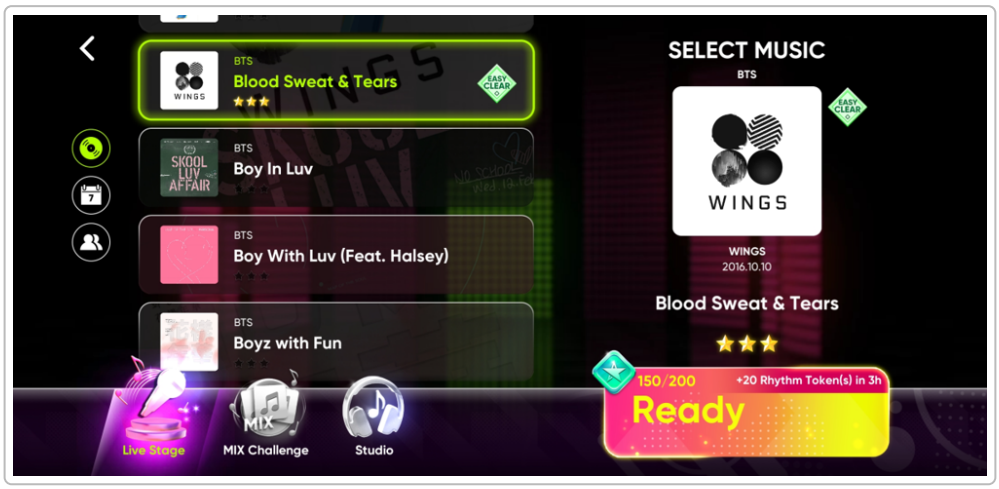
- **Game Modes:** Rhythm Hive offers several modes of play [12]:
- **Chapter Stage (Music Arcade):** A single-player "arcade" mode. You clear songs sequentially (grouped by difficulty or albums) to progress and earn rewards [13].
- **Studio Mode:** Solo play on any song (short version or full length) for practice or missions [13]. You spend *Music Points* (energy) to play; 1 point per short song, 2 per full [14].
- **Catch Live (Multiplayer):** Players form a virtual group for real-time cooperative play. Each player selects an idol (member) and contributes to the group's score. At song end, the highest individual scorer in the group is crowned "Best Performer." This live PvP rhythm mode is unique compared to typical leaderboard-based games [15] [12].
- **Cheer Mode:** A special mode where you use your device's accelerometer ("shake" gesture) in time with fan chants during a song. It's a rhythmic cheer/cheering-stick mini-game tied to specific K-pop tracks [16].



Screenshot: Rhythm Hive's gameplay UI showing the Mix Challenge (multiplayer) mode (players create a custom 3-song medley to share and compete) [17] [6] .

In gameplay, you also equip **Performance Cards** (idol-themed collectible cards) before songs. Each card boosts scores for its idol/album; one card per group member slot [18] . Cards are obtained through gacha packs and can be upgraded (e.g. combining lower-rarity cards and materials) [19] . Other features include daily/weekly missions and seasonal quests for bonus rewards, plus special challenges during events. Players earn multiple currencies (e.g. **Hive Gems** premium currency, in-game crystals, etc.) which are used for draws, upgrades, and more [20] [21] .

Artists and Music Content: Rhythm Hive's library is entirely HYBE-origin. It features **official songs by HYBE artists**: *BTS*, *TOMORROW X TOGETHER (TXT)*, *ENHYPEN*, *SEVENTEEN*, *LE SSERAFIM*, *NewJeans*, *BOYNEXTDOOR*, *ILLIT*, and *TWS* (Tomorrow X Together's Japanese unit) [22] [1] . For example, in-game you can play BTS hits like "Blood Sweat & Tears" or "Boy In Luv", as well as TXT, Seventeen, and ENHYPEN tracks. The game often includes full-length songs or specially arranged versions (some rhythm games only use clips), allowing both **full** and **short (one-verse)** versions of each track [23] [24] . Recent music updates have added new releases and alternate versions (e.g. remix versions, collaboration tracks).



Screenshot: Music selection screen in Rhythm Hive (showing BTS songs like "Blood Sweat & Tears" ready to play) [24] [7].

Beyond music, Rhythm Hive includes rich artist-centric content. Players collect **Photo Cards** and **Theme cards** featuring album art and idol images [25]. Unique to this game are *Voice Cards* and *Message Cards* (UR cards with short audio clips from the artists) and animated Live Cards [26]. Collecting cards also fills a "Diary" – players can create a custom album-themed diary for each group, decorating it with stickers of their idols and album motifs [27] [28]. These non-gameplay features (cards, diaries, messages) serve as fan collectibles. Rhythm Hive can even link to a Weverse account (HYBE's fan platform) so BTS/TXT/Enhypen/etc. fans get special login rewards [29] [30].

Recent Updates and News: The game has seen regular content patches. Early 2025 marked its 4th anniversary (Feb 4, 2025) with special events and new quests. In March 2025, a new group *ILLIT* was added as a playable artist [31]. The latest official patch (as of late 2025) was released Dec 15, 2025 [4], introducing holiday-themed events and songs (for example, the "Holiday with TWS" update was flagged on Google Play [32]). The official website (rhv-web.rhythmhive.drimage.com) and HYBE channels post regular patch notes and event announcements. There have been no service shutdown notices; the game remains active in 2026.

One notable development: On **Dec 31, 2025**, the dev team announced that *all future NewJeans content would be temporarily suspended* due to an internal review (likely related to external news about the group) [5]. They clarified that *already-owned* NewJeans cards and songs stay in the game and function normally, but no new NewJeans cards or packages are being sold for now [5]. (Players are encouraged to sell or use up NewJeans cards they acquire, since new NewJeans card draws are disabled.) Aside from this, content for other groups continues on schedule.

Monetization Model: Rhythm Hive is free-to-play with extensive optional purchases. The core monetization is a **gacha card draw** system: players spend premium currency (Hive Gems, Diamonds) to buy card packs, drawing chances to get high-rarity cards [19]. Hive Gems themselves are sold in packs (e.g. 12 Gems for $0.99) [20], and can also be earned slowly through gameplay. The game also offers **limited-time gacha promotions** (step-up draws, event banners) and sells premium **collection packages** (e.g. "Fan Plus" packs themed to a specific group) with guaranteed cards. According to the App Store, there are also **monthly subscription products**: for example, a "Hive Pass" ($4.99) that grants bonus music points or currency each day, and a "Fan Plus" ($6.49) offering an upfront gem bonus [33]. The official notices confirm *limited-time subscription products* regularly go on sale (5-day passes with login bonuses) [34]. Additionally, many events include a paid "Catch Pass" (season pass) for the event, giving extra rewards for completing song challenges. Some user reviews criticize this model; one player noted that later updates "became clearly just another way to pull money out of the fans," citing restrictions on songs and diary materials behind paid currency [35].

Platform & Requirements: Rhythm Hive runs on Android and iOS. The App Store listing shows **requires iOS 15.0 or later** (iPhone/iPad) [36]. The Android version historically supported very old devices (Android 5.1+) according to the official support site [21], though newer updates may demand more recent OS. Both platforms need at least **~2GB of RAM** for smooth play [21]. The download size is several hundred MB (e.g. ~355 MB on iOS [37]). (Note: iOS minimum is now iOS 15+, even though older support said iOS 11).

Comparison to Other Rhythm Games: Unlike standalone rhythm games like *Cytus* or *Deemo* (which feature original soundtracks and static backgrounds), Rhythm Hive is a branded K-pop game. Its visuals and

interface closely resemble other HYBE rhythm titles and even borrow UI elements from anime rhythm games (some players note similarity to *Project Sekai*), but it stands out by using real pop songs and idol imagery. One reviewer praised that Rhythm Hive lets you play *full songs*, a rarity among music games [23]. In contrast to *Project Sekai* (which has an anime style and Vocaloid tracks) or *Cytus*/*Deemo* (which are single-player only and not gacha), Rhythm Hive is strongly social and collectible-focused: it emphasizes card-collecting, customization, and fan interactions (diaries, voice messages, Weverse link) beyond pure rhythm gameplay.

Reception: The game enjoys moderately positive reviews from fans. On Google Play it has a **4.3-star** rating from ~300K reviews [38]; the iOS App Store shows 4.2/5 from dozens of ratings [39]. Fans praise the large song library and idol content. However, feedback is mixed: common complaints include frequent app crashes or freezes (especially during card draws) [40], and frustration over aggressive monetization. For example, one long-term player noted "game modes are great…but it's all sullied by diary materials being restricted to paid currency, and playable songs restricted by the cards in your collection" [35]. Developer responses on the store assure players they welcome feedback and aim to improve stability [41] [42]. Overall, Rhythm Hive is regarded as fun for K-pop fans, especially early on, but some feel the game has become more pay-to-progress over time.

Sources: Official app store descriptions [43] [24], HYBE developer Q&A (system requirements) [21], and fan-compiled updates [31] inform most factual details. Player reviews [40] [35] and community posts [5] provide insight on recent news and user sentiment.

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